

Phishing Email Detection & Awareness Report

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Tools Used: Sample Phishing Emails, Browser, Microsoft Word

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a cyberattack in which attackers impersonate trusted organizations to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, and banking details. This report analyzes sample emails to identify phishing indicators and recommends preventive measures to improve user awareness and security.

2. Phishing Indicators

The following indicators were used to identify phishing emails:

- Fake or spoofed sender email address
- Urgent or threatening language
- Suspicious or misleading links
- Generic greetings such as "Dear Customer"
- Requests for sensitive information
- Spelling or grammatical mistakes
- Unknown attachments

3. Email Analysis

Email 1 – Bank Alert

Classification: Phishing

Indicators Found

- Fake sender address (support@paypal-security.com)

- Suspicious website link
- Urgent request to verify the account
- Threat of account closure within 24 hours
- Generic greeting ("Dear Customer")

Risk: High

Email 2 – University Notice

Classification: Safe

Indicators Found

- Official university sender address
- Professional language
- No suspicious links
- No request for sensitive information

Risk: Low

Email 3 – Password Reset

Classification: Suspicious

Indicators Found

- Unknown sender
- Password-related message
- Requires verification before taking action

Risk: Medium

4. Email Classification Table

Email	Classification
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Bank Alert	Phishing
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University Notice	Safe
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Password Reset	Suspicious
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5. Prevention Guidelines

To reduce the risk of phishing attacks:

- Verify the sender's email address before responding.
- Avoid clicking suspicious or unknown links.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Do not download unexpected attachments.
- Keep antivirus software updated.
- Report phishing emails to the organization's IT or security team.
- Always access websites by typing the official URL instead of clicking email links.

6. Conclusion

The analysis identified several phishing indicators, including fake sender addresses, suspicious links, and urgent language designed to pressure users into acting quickly. Users should verify email authenticity before responding or clicking links. Following basic cybersecurity practices and security awareness guidelines can significantly reduce the risk of phishing attacks.

7. Tools Used

- Public Sample Emails
- Browser
- Microsoft Word